

feature glassy interface elements with blurred transparency (reminiscent of Windows' Aero theme) and a taskbar at the bottom with an application menu on the left and system tray icons on the right.

KDE has a reputation for being the most resource-intensive Desktop Environment, but not without reason. The attention to detail combined with the detailed, beautiful graphics have become a hallmark of KDE and come at a price. It uses an entirely different Window Manager called KWin, with a different graphics toolkit called Qt (as opposed to GNOME's Gtk).



KDE's default desktop resembles Windows quite closely, with a few unique features of its own.

This results in native KDE applications looking slightly out of place in GNOME/Unity and vice-versa.

4. XFCE and LXDE

Both XFCE and LXDE are minimalist and lightweight alternatives to their bloated counterparts like KDE and GNOME. Both use OpenBox as the default Window Manager, which is highly configurable with an array of scripts and plugins to bend it to your will. Both stick to a fairly traditional desktop, with the usual serving of a taskbar, application / settings menu and a system tray on the right. Though, of course, you can always change it to your liking. Additionally, these DEs use the standard Gtk toolkit for creating GUI apps, which means any application written for GNOME / Unity will blend in really well with the rest of the desktop. Apart from being